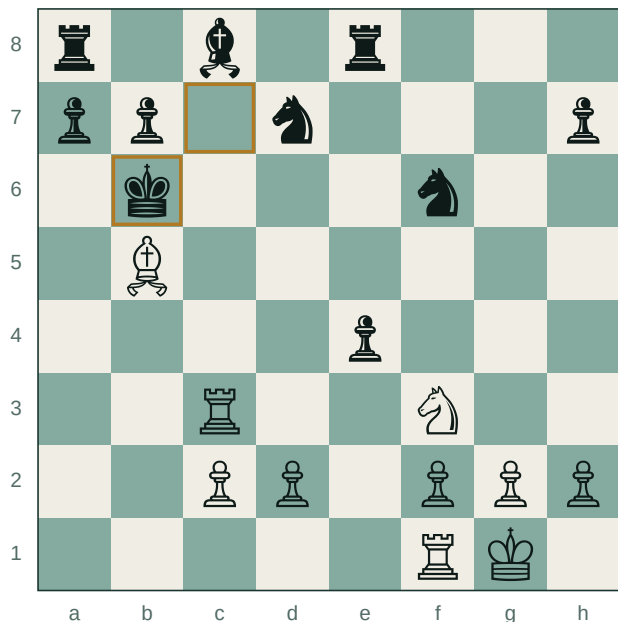


Discovered checks: White, move 20

Discovered checks

White to move



Previous move: 19...Kb6. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

20. Rb1 a6 21. Bxd7+ Ka7 22. Bxe8

20.Rb1 The rook moves from f1 to b1. Recorded reply: **20...a6**.

21.Bxd7+ Check restricts Black to 2 legal replies here. From d7 it attacks rook on e8 and bishop on c8. Recorded reply: **21...Ka7**.

22.Bxe8 The bishop captures the rook on e8.

At the end, nominal material is White 21 / Black 15 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, White's balance changes by +8. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

CHECKPOINT

Using P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9, how much does White's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer:** +8: the balance goes from -2 to +6. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

The checking line must actually be clear, and moving the blocker must not expose your own king to check.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

A discovered check opens a line toward the king by moving the blocking piece. Because check must be answered, the moving piece may gain a free tempo for another threat.

HOW TO LOOK

Trace the hidden checking line first. Then examine where the blocker can move to attack or capture something important.

The defending king is on b6. Geometrically undefended: rook on a8. Check for tactical protection.